

Beta Cattle Tracker — Troubleshooting

Plain-English fixes for the things most likely to go wrong in the field. Issues are roughly ordered by how often they come up.

1. "I saved a record but it's not in my spreadsheet"

Most likely cause: No cell signal at the time. The record is safe locally and will sync when reception comes back.

Check: Look at the badge next to the  **Pull Cloud History** button.

- "⚠ Offline" → You have no signal. Records will sync automatically when you regain it.
- "⌛ N pending" → Records are queued. The app retries every minute and on reconnect.
- No badge → Everything is synced. If the record still isn't in the sheet, something else is going on (see #2).

What to do: Drive to a known-good signal area. Watch the badge — it should drop the count. If it's been more than a few minutes with full signal and the queue isn't clearing, force-quit and reopen the app.

Don't: Tap **Pull Cloud History** to "fix" missing records. That button only downloads — it doesn't push your queued records up. Pulling is safe (your queue is preserved), but it doesn't help with this problem.

2. "I have signal but the queue isn't clearing"

Possible causes:

- The Google Apps Script behind the cloud URL is down or has been redeployed.
- The data has bad characters or is too large for one request.

What to do:

- Toggle airplane mode on then off.
 - Force-quit the app and reopen.
 - If the queue is still stuck, contact whoever set up the Google Sheet.
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3. "Records I deleted came back after Pull Cloud History"

Should not happen. The app uses tombstones — when you delete a record, it remembers that ID was deleted and refuses to bring it back from a cloud pull.

If you see this anyway: You're probably running a cached old version. Clear Safari website data and re-add the app to your home screen.

4. "The keypad won't open when I tap Tag #"

- Use a quick tap — under half a second. Long-pressing shows a tooltip instead.
 - On a desktop or device with a hardware keyboard, the keypad doesn't pop up at all — just type the tag and press Enter.
 - If still stuck, force-quit and reopen.
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5. "I locked Action and the meds aren't filling in"

- Save at least one record with that action first so the protocol is cached.
 - Pull Cloud History to refresh the protocols list.
 - Make sure the action name in your spreadsheet exactly matches the dropdown option.
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6. "I locked Pasture but Ranch unlocked itself"

This is by design. Pasture can't be locked without its Ranch — it would create a broken state when you open the app fresh. Locking Pasture auto-locks Ranch; unlocking Ranch auto-unlocks Pasture. To unlock just the Pasture and keep working different pastures within the same ranch, tap the Pasture lock when it's green.

7. "SAFETY CHECK FAILED" message

The app refuses certain actions to protect data integrity:

- "Tag X already has a 1st Pull" → Pick 2nd Pull instead, or edit the existing record.
- "Tag X already has a 2nd Pull" → Edit or delete the existing record if wrong.
- "Cannot record a 2nd Pull without a 1st Pull" → Record the 1st Pull first, or check the tag.

- **"Tag X is already marked as Dead"** → Verify the tag number.
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8. **"Missing: Crew Member, Tag, Action, Ranch" toast**

You tapped Save with one or more required fields empty. Fill in the named fields and try again.

9. **"App froze / stopped responding"**

Force-quit (swipe up from the bottom, swipe the app's card up). Reopen. Your data is safe — local records, the sync queue, and field locks all persist across restarts.

10. **"I edited a record from yesterday and the time is now today"**

Should not happen any more. Edits preserve the original time. The date you can change manually if needed; the time stays as recorded.

If you see this on an old record, that record was created before this fix. Manually correct it in the spreadsheet if needed.

11. **"Pasture dropdown is empty after I picked a Ranch"**

That ranch has no pastures defined in the cloud spreadsheet. Either add pastures to the locations tab in the sheet (then Pull Cloud History), or pick a different ranch.

12. **"Save button does nothing when I tap it"**

- A required field is empty. The toast at the bottom tells you which.
 - Or you're inside the 600ms cooldown after a previous tap. Wait a second.
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13. **"Two records got saved when I only tapped Save once"**

Should not happen. The submit button locks immediately on tap and refuses additional submits for 600ms.

If you see duplicates in the spreadsheet:

- Check whether two phones are recording at once.
 - Delete the duplicate from the History tab.
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14. "App loads but everything looks blank or broken"

Bad cache from a partial update. Clear Safari website data and reinstall:

1. Force-quit the app.
2. Settings → Safari → Clear History and Website Data.
3. Open the web address again.
4. Re-add to home screen.

Local data is gone if Safari's website data was also cleared. Pull Cloud History to restore from the sheet.

15. "Pull Cloud History says ✗ Data Error"

The cloud script returned something the app can't read. Wait a few minutes and try again. If it keeps failing, the spreadsheet's Apps Script needs attention.

16. "The medication list is missing a med I need"

The dropdown is populated from the medications tab in the cloud spreadsheet. Add the med there, then Pull Cloud History. For one-off use, type the med name directly into the field — it doesn't have to match the dropdown.

17. "App icon disappeared from home screen"

Re-add it from Safari (share icon → Add to Home Screen). If Safari website data was also cleared, your local records are gone — Pull Cloud History to restore.

18. "Storage full — pruned N old records" warning

Records older than 60 days were automatically removed from local storage to make room — the cloud spreadsheet still has them. No action needed.

If you see "🔴 Storage full. Pull Cloud, then clear app data." that means pruning didn't free enough space. Pull Cloud History to confirm everything's synced, then clear Safari website data and re-add to home screen.

When to Call for Help

Most issues clear with: force-quit, reopen, wait for sync. If something still doesn't work, report it with:

1. What you tapped right before the problem.
 2. What the badge next to Pull Cloud History was showing.
 3. Whether you had cell signal at the time.
 4. How many records you'd saved that day before it broke.
 5. Screenshot if possible.
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Emergency: "I'm in the pasture and it just won't work"

Pull out a notebook. Write down: tag, ranch, pasture, lot, action, meds with doses, your name, time. Type them into the app later that evening with Wi-Fi. The doctoring is more important than the app.